



Airport Face Scans

Airport face scanning technology may be creepy, but it is gaining tracking since the process has been speeding up. <https://digit.in/dec18-118-1>



Smart backpack for chicken?

A team has built smart mini-backpacks for chickens which will track their behaviour and welfare on farms. <https://digit.in/dec18-118-2>

THE FERMITRON CONSPIRACY

As an alien civilisation aims to rain devastation on the inner worlds, the Earth prepares to fight back by building an antimatter factory in space to deflect the interstellar asteroids.

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17 NOVEMBER 2134

Washington DC, USA

Damien Thibodeau was pouring over threat response scenarios for a new class of interstellar objects in the Planetary Defence Coordination Office at NASA Headquarters. The first object of this type, Oumuamua had been discovered over a hundred years ago. Since then, almost every year, about five to six of these interstellar visitors had been discovered. His job involved identifying any potential asteroids that could impact the Earth. An impact from a large asteroid from within the solar system was devastating enough, but considering the speed at which the interstellar asteroids travelled, any impact would be cataclysmic. To deflect any such asteroids with available technologies, they had to be identified at least beyond

the orbit of Eris, or a decade before any potential strikes. The fleet of space telescopes dedicated to the task were just not sensitive enough to identify and track the visitors from distant solar systems within the time windows required.

This worried Thibodeau. He started preparing a report that pressed for dedicating more resources towards identifying interstellar objects. Project Spaceguard needed serious upgrades.

12 JULY, 2196

Pasadena, USA

The Piazzi space telescope had flagged an interesting object. Xiu Fen had simulated the trajectory of 11/2206 U4 as a matter of routine, to check if there were any opportuni-